

Well Ordering and the Induction Principle

- **Exercise 1**

Consider $A = \{n \in \mathbb{Z} : n > 10\}$.

1. Give 5 different lower bounds of A .
2. Which of those lower bounds belong to A ?
3. Find $\min A$.
4. Explain why 10 is not the minimum.

- **Solution 1.1**

1. 10, 9, 8, 7, 6.
 2. None.
 3. As A is bounded below, $\min A$ exists. Since $n \geq 10 + 1 = 11$, 11 is a lower bound of A . Since $11 \in A$, we have $11 = \min A$.
 4. $10 \notin A$.
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- **Exercise 2**

Prove that $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, 1 + 3 + \dots + (2n - 1) = n^2$.

- **Proof 2.1**

By induction.

1. Base step
If $n = 1$ the result is true because $1 = 1^2$.
2. Inductive step
Suppose that the result is true for n , that is

$$1 + 3 + \dots + (2n - 1) = n^2.$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned} 1 + 3 + \dots + (2n - 1) + (2(n + 1) - 1) &= (1 + 3 + \dots + (2n - 1)) + (2n + 1) \\ &= n^2 + 2n + 1 \\ &= (n + 1)^2. \end{aligned}$$

Then the result is true for $n + 1$ and therefore

$$1 + 3 + \dots + (2n - 1) = n^2,$$

is true for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

- **Exercise 3**

Prove that $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, 2^n \geq n + 1$.

- **Proof 3.1**

By induction.

1. Base step
If $n = 1$ the result is true because $2^1 \geq 1 + 1$.
2. Inductive step
Suppose that the result is true for n , that is

$$2^n \geq n + 1.$$

Because $n \geq 1$, $2n \geq n$, hence

$$2^{n+1} = 2 \cdot 2^n \geq 2 \cdot (n + 1) = 2n + 2 \geq (n + 1) + 1.$$

Then the result is true for $n + 1$ and therefore

$$2^n \geq n + 1,$$

is true for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

• **Exercise 4**

Prove that $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, n \geq 4, 2^n \geq n^2$.

◦ **Proof 4.1**

By induction.

1. Base step

If $n = 4$ the result is true since $2^4 = 16 \geq 16 = 4^2$.

2. Inductive step

Suppose that the result is true for $n \geq 4$, that is

$$2^n \geq n^2.$$

Hence

$$\begin{aligned} 2^{n+1} &= 2 \cdot 2^n \\ &\geq 2n^2 \\ &= n^2 + n^2. \end{aligned}$$

Since $n \geq 4$, we have that $n^2 \geq 4n = 2n + 2n > 2n + 1$. Therefore

$$2^{n+1} \geq n^2 + 2n + 1 = (n + 1)^2.$$

Then the result is true for $n + 1$ and therefore

$$2^n \geq n^2,$$

is true for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$ with $n \geq 4$.

• **Exercise 5**

Prove that $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, 3 \mid (4^n - 1)$.

◦ **Proof 5.1**

By induction.

1. Base step

If $n = 1$ the result is true since $3 \mid (4^1 - 1)$.

2. Inductive step

Suppose that the result is true for n , that is

$$3 \mid (4^n - 1).$$

By definition, $\exists k \in \mathbb{Z}, 4^n - 1 = 3k \implies 4^n = 3k + 1$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
4^{n+1} - 1 &= 4 \cdot 4^n - 1 \\
&= 4 \cdot (3k + 1) - 1 \\
&= 12k + 3 \\
&= 3 \cdot (4k + 1).
\end{aligned}$$

Since $4k + 1 \in \mathbb{Z}$, $3 \mid (4^{n+1} - 1)$. Then the result is true for $n + 1$ and therefore

$$3 \mid (4^n - 1)$$

is true for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

• **Exercise 6 (Fibonacci Inequality)**

Prove that $\forall n \in \mathbb{N}, F_n < 2^n$ where F_n is defined by $F_1 = 1, F_2 = 1, F_{n+2} = F_{n+1} + F_n$.

◦ **Proof 6.1**

By induction.

1. Base step

If $n = 1, 2$ the result is true since $F_1 = 1 < 2 = 2^1, F_2 = 1 < 4 = 2^2$.

2. Inductive step

Suppose that the result is true for both n and $n + 1$, that is

$$F_n < 2^n \wedge F_{n+1} < 2^{n+1}.$$

By definition

$$\begin{aligned}
F_{n+2} &= F_{n+1} + F_n \\
&< 2^{n+1} + 2^n \\
&< 2^{n+2}.
\end{aligned}$$

Then the result is true for $n + 2$ and therefore

$$F_n < 2^n,$$

is true for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$.

• **Exercise 7 (Intersection of lines)**

Suppose that n lines are drawn in the plane so that

1. no two lines are parallel;
2. no three lines pass through the same point.

Prove that the number of intersection points is $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$.

◦ **Proof 7.1**

By induction.

1. Base step

If $n = 1$ the result is true since the number of intersection points is $0 = \frac{1(1-1)}{2}$.

2. Inductive step

Suppose that the result is true for n , that is, any n lines satisfying the conditions have

$$\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$$

intersection points.

Now consider the case with $n + 1$ lines. When we add the $(n + 1)$ -th line to the existing n lines:

- Since no two lines are parallel, the new line must intersect with all of the existing n lines, creating n new intersection points.
- Since no three lines pass through the same point, all of these n new intersection points are distinct from the previous ones.

Hence, the total number of intersection points for $n + 1$ lines is

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{n(n-1)}{2} + n &= \frac{n(n-1) + 2n}{2} \\ &= \frac{n^2 - n + 2n}{2} \\ &= \frac{n^2 + n}{2} \\ &= \frac{(n+1)n}{2}.\end{aligned}$$

Then the result is true for $n + 1$ and therefore the number of intersection points is $\frac{n(n-1)}{2}$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$.